May 18. It was a beautiful job and well done. She had worked long and hard.

3

But what about a different apartment? What about one that was not a steambox in the summer?

The trouble was that we were confined to the public transportation lines and decent apartments were invariably nowhere near those lines. The alternative was to buy a car, but neither Gertrude nor I could drive one; and I, for one, was afraid to drive one.

Gertrude was less afraid, and on May 16, 1950, her birthday, she celebrated by taking her first driving lesson. I was rather awed by her courage and I suggested that if she learned how to drive, we could get a car and she could chauffeur me when necessary.

The lessons continued through the month, by the end of which I had completed my first year at the Medical School. The Medical School wasn't bad, all told. It was infinitely more congenial than the Navy Yard had been, and Boston in peace was more colorful and pleasant than Philadelphia in wartime had been. I was not unhappy.

And The Stars, like Dust— was now racing ahead. I was at it every day and it was giving me no trouble.

On May 31, 1950, I celebrated the completion of my first year at the Medical School by being on a local radio talk show. I listened to a tape of myself the next day and was horrified to find that I sounded exactly like Stanley. Everyone, at my urgent questioning, assured me that that was exactly how I sounded. Apparently, my voice, sounding in my own ears through the bone cavities of my skull, sounds much deeper and resonant than it sounds to others.

4

Bill Boyd was back on June 2, 1950. He had not even waited till September. It had, apparently, been a very disillusioning experience, but I think he was humiliated at having once more to come back to the Medical School.

He said to me, "Do you remember, Isaac, when you outlined to me all the unpleasant things that happened at a civil-service job?"